HARSHITH ROSHAN KRISHNA KUMAR

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EDUCATION

B.Sc. PSYCHOLOGY (Hons. with Research) **Minors in Biology and Philosophy**	Ashoka University	CGPA: **3.86/4** Major GPA: **3.95/4**	2027
SEMESTER EXCHANGE PROGRAM	University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill	GPA: **4/4**	2026
CLASS XII (CBSE)	The PSBB Millennium School, Chennai	**486/500**	2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

FAMILY JOURNEYS CO-LAB - UNC CHAPEL HILL | *Research Assistant* | *Developmental Psychopathology* **Jan 2026 - May 2026**

- Conducted abstract screening for a **systematic review** of the developmental internalizing pathway to substance use disorders, using **Covidence** to classify **100+ papers** across six developmental components of the framework. Participated in a **seminar series** on substance use in college campuses.
- Evaluated program data for **22 adolescents** in the Reintegration Support Network (RSN), integrating referral, risk-assessment, mentor-interaction, evaluation, and interview records to identify **risk factors, engagement patterns, and outcomes**; synthesized findings into a 29-page final report.

NEUROETHOLOGY LAB | *Research Assistant* | *Quantitative Cognition in Zebrafish* **Jul 2025 - Dec 2025**

- Developed and refined experimental paradigms investigating **zebrafish quantity discrimination**, including a dot-splitting paradigm and ratio-comparison task in a **T-maze** to examine preferences for larger vs smaller quantities and the influence of dot size and shape on preferences.
- Engineered experimental apparatus and visual stimuli, conducted **20+ behavioural trials**, and collected and analyzed behavioural data using **BORIS**.
- Conducted a comprehensive literature review of **15+ studies**, presented findings to the lab team, and contributed to drafting a **publication proposal**.

PROFESSOR NASEER'S LAB | *Research Intern* | *Scale Adaptation for Drug Abuse Screening* **Aug 2024 - Dec 2024**

- Conducted **literature reviews** on culturally adapted substance-use assessments, identifying limitations and gaps in existing Indian adaptations to inform the adaptation of the **DAST-10** in **Hindi**. **Peer-reviewed** research proposals and assisted in refining the study design and research methodology.
- Developed protocols and flowcharts for **cross-cultural adaptation** and **psychometric validation** of the scale, including selection of complementary measures (ASSIST, PHQ-9, GAD-7). Designed a **Qualtrics survey** examining the relationship between **religious values** and **moral decision-making**.

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

RELA HOSPITAL AND INSTITUTE | *Clinical Psychology Intern* **Jun 2026 - Jul 2026**

- Administered, scored, and interpreted **MoCA/MMSE** assessments and conducted **Mental Status Examinations** for 5+ patients, under supervision.
- Participated in clinical assessment and case discussions with clinical psychologists and psychiatrists on **CBT, ACT, family** and **grief counselling**.
- Evaluated post-surgical psychological recovery and adaptive functioning for **20+ living liver donors** via structured clinical follow-up interviews.
- Observed counselling and outpatient consultations across **liver transplantation, Neurological ICU, palliative care, and medical/radiation oncology**.

PROJECTS

UNDERGRADUATE THESIS | *Differential Effects of Childhood Emotional Abuse & Neglect on Inhibitory Control* **Jul 2026 - Present**

- Investigating whether childhood emotional abuse and emotional neglect differentially relate to inhibitory control in Indian emerging adults, using the **Traumatic Antecedents Questionnaire** subscale scores and an **emotional Go/No-Go task** with positive, negative, and neutral distractor stimuli.
- Developed a pilot version in **PsychoPy** while **prevalidating** emotional stimuli for valence and arousal and TAQ items for cultural relevance, and designed the study protocol and recruitment strategy for a target **sample of 150**, based on an a priori power analysis using **G*Power**.

EYES ON THE TASK | *Cognitive Load, Distractors and Attention* **Jan 2025 - Jun 2025**

- Evaluated effects of cognitive load and distractor relevance on visual attention using **Tobii Pro Fusion eye tracker** in a 2×2 within-subjects experiment.
- Designed the experiment on **PsychoPy**, including eye-tracker calibration and manual coding of gaze-point data; analyzed data in **Jamovi** using two-way repeated-measures ANOVA, finding significant effects of **distractor relevance** and its interaction with task difficulty on attentional distraction. - Link

POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

GAMING & COGNITION (PSY-4022) | *Teaching Assistant* **Aug 2026 - Dec 2026**

- Conducted **office hours** to clarify course concepts, address student queries, and discuss project ideas. Compiled useful supplementary resources.
- Facilitated **discussion sections** alongside the Teaching Fellow, encouraging active participation and collaborative learning within a class of **50 students**.
- **Graded quizzes**, assisted in curriculum refinement, and supported students with projects involving **game development** and **game-based learning**.

ASHOKA BEHAVIORAL INSIGHTS TEAM | *HOD/ Chief Editor* **Aug 2025 - Aug 2026**

- Led **The Nudgelet**, a 20+ member team translating behavioural science research into accessible and comprehensible articles on everyday phenomena.
- Authored *"Are You in Love, or Just Afraid of Being Single?"* after designing and analyzing a campus **survey** of **37 responses** using qualitative and quantitative approaches to examine **relationship FOMO**. Results showed that the majority of the respondents were influenced by FOMO. - Link
- Authored articles on **optimism bias** and **voluntariness principle** for the Centre for Social & Behavioral Change's *A-Z of Behavioral Science* handbook.

ASHOKA DEBATING UNION | *President* **Aug 2024 - Jun 2025**

- Led a community of **80+ debaters**, organized mock debates, intra and inter-varsity competitions, and training sessions with the Indian Debating League.
- Participated in **25+ parliamentary debates** as adjudicator and speaker, earning multiple competitive accolades and more than **INR 60,000** as cash prize.

AWARDS AND ACCOMPLISHMENTS

DEAN'S LIST STUDENT | Ashoka University **Jan 2024 - Present**

- Named to the Dean's List every semester to date by securing a GPA of more than 3.67 | Currently holding a **3.95 Major CGPA** in Psychology.

SCHOOL TOPPER/ HEAD BOY | The PSBB Millennium School **Mar 2023**

- Ranked **1st in class** with a **100/100 in Biology**; led a school of **2,000+ students**, organized inter-school fests, served on disciplinary committees and as President of the Model UN Society, delivered **10+** training sessions/ workshops and represented the school at **20+ events** and conferences.

RESEARCH SKILLS: • **Data Tools & Softwares -** PsychoPy, Covidence, Qualtrics, BORIS, Jamovi, SPSS, G*Power, Tobii Pro Fusion, Zotero, Excel
• **Biophysiology & Assessments** - ECG, Galvanic Skin Response, Structured Clinical Interview, Mental Status Examination